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2025 Nursing Research Conference

Nursing Research Conference

9-30-2025

From Delays to Dialogue, Investigating Team Communication and Patient Safety Culture In an Endoscopy Unit

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Recommended Citation

Archer, Vetra; Mahal, Rupinder K.; and Tate, Nutrena, "From Delays to Dialogue, Investigating Team Communication and Patient Safety Culture In an Endoscopy Unit" (2025). *2025 Nursing Research Conference*. 14.

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BACKGROUND/PURPOSE

- Patient safety culture is the extent to which an organization's culture supports and promotes patient safety
- It refers to the values, beliefs, and norms that are shared by healthcare practitioners and other staff throughout the organization that influence their actions and behaviors (1)
- Effective communication among clinical teams is foundational to patient safety, especially in high-throughput environments like endoscopy units
- Henry Ford West Bloomfield Hospital's (HFWB) Endoscopy Unit experienced inconsistent on-time procedural starts, with contributing factors including late consents and insufficient team updates
- This Quality Improvement project investigated the relationship between communication breakdowns, procedural delays and patient safety culture
- The project aligns with The Joint Commission's 2025 National Patient Safety Goal to Improve Staff Communication (2) (3)

METHODS/DATA COLLECTION

- ❑ We employed a mixed-methods quality improvement study using retrospective data analysis and a communication perception survey
- ❑ Pareto chart data and Best Outcomes logs from the unit's Lean Daily Management Board were reviewed, from November 2024 – June 2025
- ❑ Analysis included:
Frequency counts from Pareto chart data.
Best Outcomes logs reviewed for percentage of days target met.

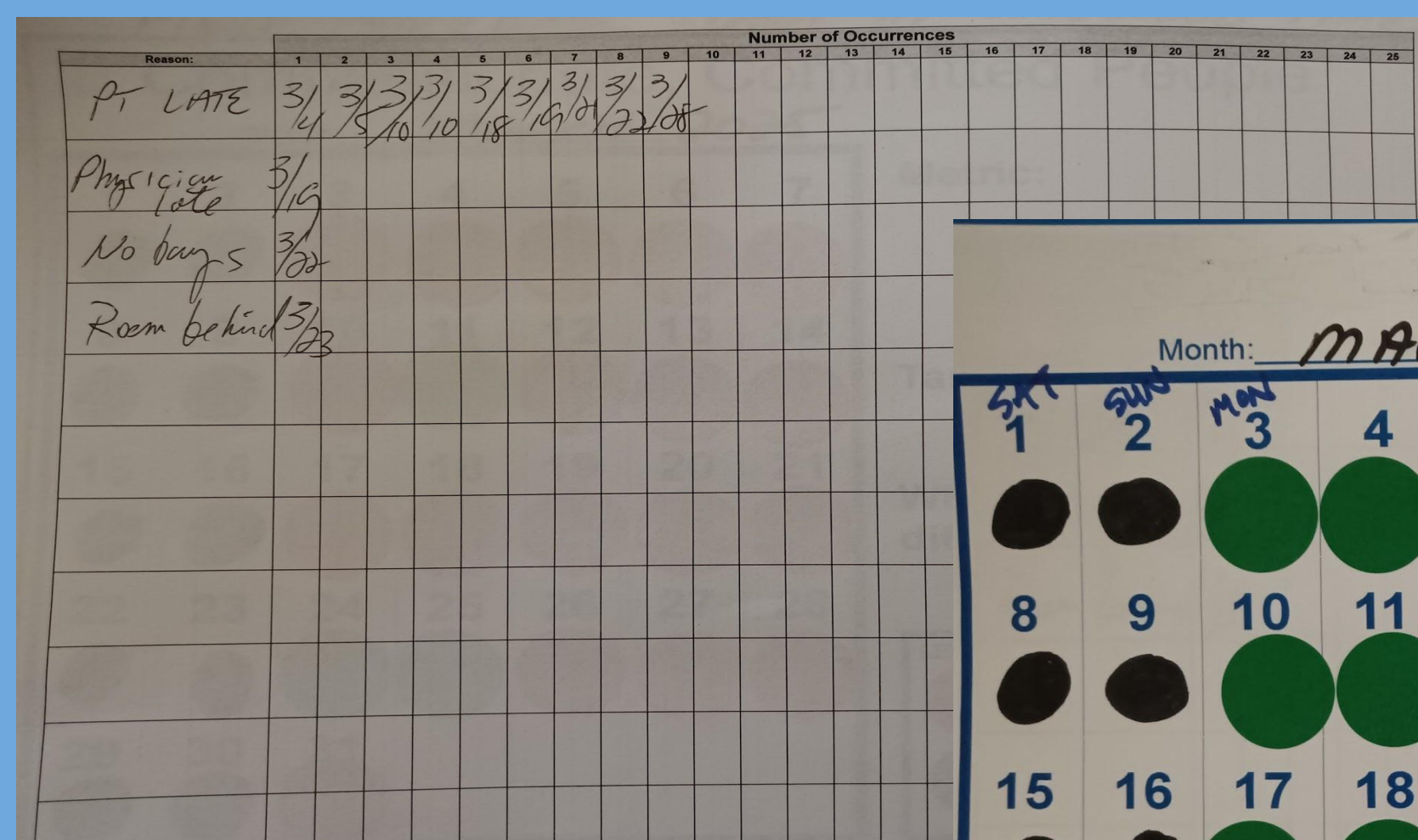


Figure 1: Pareto Chart

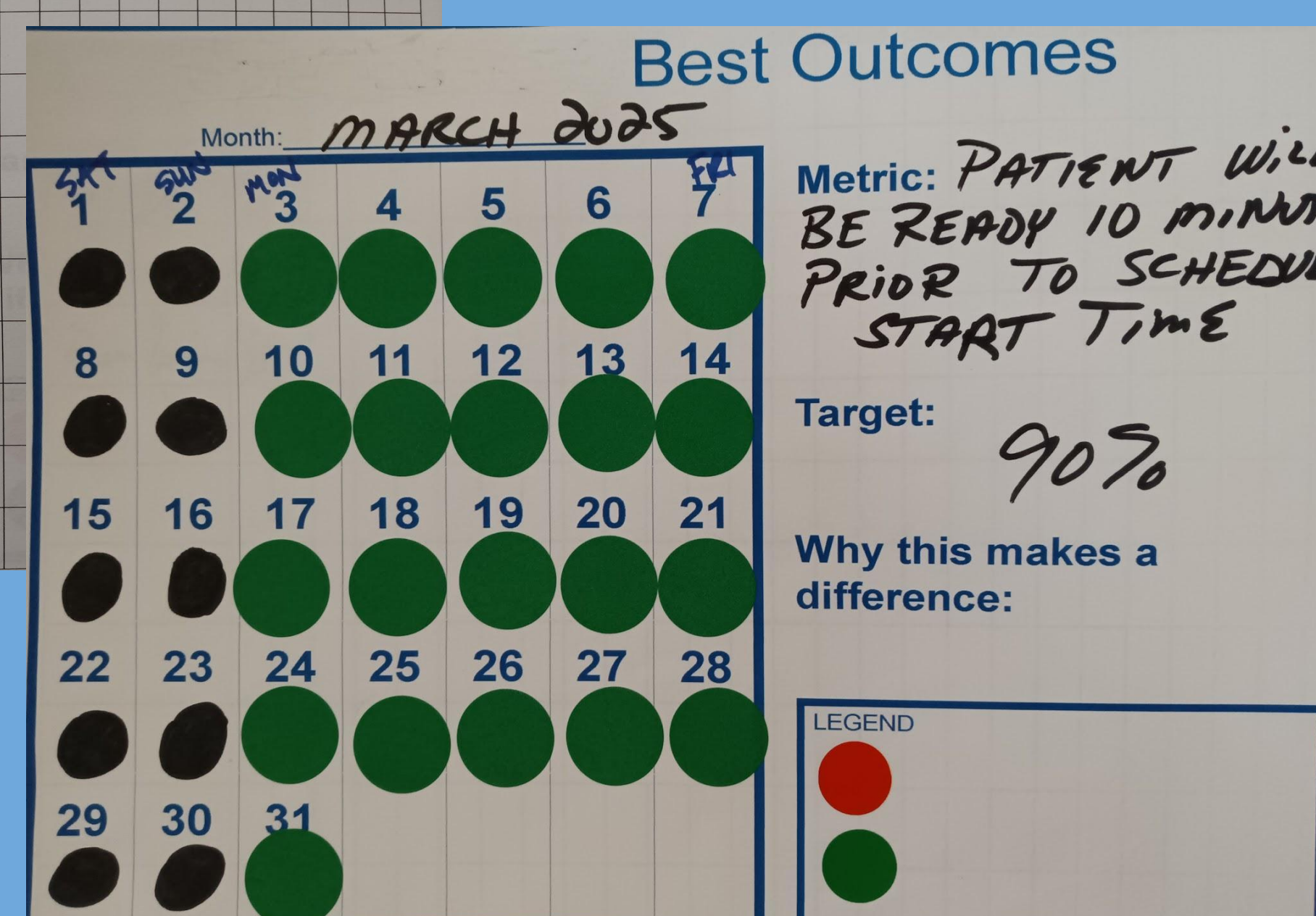


Figure 2: Best Outcomes Log

SAMPLE/SETTING

- ❑ Endoscopy Nurses, Technicians, Anesthesia, Physicians and Support Staff
- ❑ HFWB Endoscopy Department

RESULTS

- Quantitative Review showed "Patient Late" as the most frequent contributor to delays
- Staff expressed a need for daily interdisciplinary huddles and "fast-tracking" Pre-Op process
- Pareto Chart review identified: "Patient Late", "Consent Late" and "Unknowns" as leading contributors to delays
- Best Outcomes showed the unit met/exceeded its target (90% readiness) 5 out of the 7 months reviewed

DISCUSSION

- ❑ Improving interdepartmental communication through consistent utilization of unit-approved interventions may significantly improve FCOTS rates.
- ❑ Findings suggest targeted interventions like pre-procedure huddles, utilizing communication technologies and fast-tracking Pre-Op Process could reduce preventable delays.

INTERVENTIONS/FUTURE STEPS

- HFWB Endoscopy Unit used the results of our data collection and utilized management recommended, targeted interventions
- Interventions include Pre-procedure Huddles, Communication technologies (HALO/Symplr), and Procedure On-Time Start Process to improve communications and to reduce preventable delays in first case on start times starts (FCOTS)
- Phase II includes assessment of the current communication and patient safety culture, using a validated web- survey, developed by the Agency for Healthcare Research and Quality (AHRQ)



ACKNOWLEDGEMENTS



- ❑ HFWB Endoscopy Nurses
- ❑ Dr Nutrena Tate PhD MBA RN CPNP-PC, Director, Nursing Research, Henry Ford Health
- ❑ Stefanie Roberts Newman MSN RN NEA-BC, Chief Nursing Officer, HFWB
- ❑ Deborah Jenkins, Director, Surgical Services, HFWB
- ❑ Rupinder Mahal, Nurse Manager, PACU, HFWB

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- (3) The Joint Commission. (2025). Hospital Chapter, Simplified Version. National Patient Safety Goals. Retrieved from <https://www.jointcommission.org/en-us/standards/national-patient-safety-goals>

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